The future with will and going to

Goal: To talk about future plans, predictions and decisions using *will* and *be going to*, and to choose the right form according to the situation (a plan already made, a sudden decision, a prediction with or without evidence).

The idea in two lines: *Be going to* is for intentions decided before speaking and for predictions based on what we can see now. *Will* is for decisions made at the moment of speaking, promises, offers and predictions based on opinion.

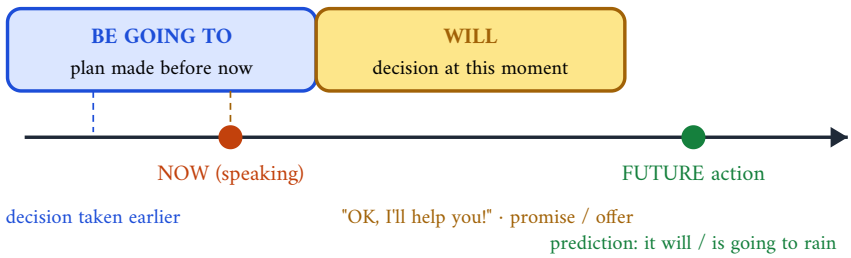


Figure 1: Going to = decided before the moment of speaking; will = decided now, or a promise, offer or opinion about the future.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Form of will:** subject + *will* + base verb (*I will / I'll study*). Negative: *will not = won't*. Question: *Will you study?* The form is the same for all persons.
2. **Form of going to:** subject + *am / is / are* + *going to* + base verb (*She is going to study*). Negative: *isn't going to*. Question: *Is she going to study?*
3. **Plans and intentions** (decided before): going to. *I'm going to be a doctor.*
4. **Instant decisions, offers, promises:** will. *The phone is ringing. I'll answer it. / I'll always help you.*
5. **Predictions with evidence** (we see signs now): going to. *Look at those clouds! It's going to rain.*
6. **Predictions from opinion** (I think, I'm sure, probably): will. *I think robots will do most jobs in 2050.*

7. Common future time words: *tomorrow, next week, in two years, soon, one day, when I grow up.*

🟢 Examples

1. Complete: *Yasmine has bought a camera. She ..... (take) photos of the Casbah.* **Solution:** She **is going to take** photos of the Casbah. **Explanation:** buying the camera shows the plan was made before.
2. Complete: *"We have no bread." – "Don't worry, I ..... (buy) some."* **Solution:** I **'ll buy** some. **Explanation:** the decision is taken at the moment of speaking.
3. Complete: *I'm sure you ..... (pass) the BEM exam.* **Solution:** you **will pass**. **Explanation:** *I'm sure* shows a personal opinion, so *will*.

🟠 Common BEM mistakes

- Adding -s or -ed after *will*: *He will goes* ✗ → *He will go* ✓.
- Forgetting the verb *be*: *She going to travel* ✗ → *She is going to travel* ✓.
- Using *to* after *will*: *I will to study* ✗.
- Using *will* for a plan already made with a clear sign (e.g. tickets bought): prefer *going to*.

🟡 Quick review

- will + base verb; be going to + base verb.
- Plan made before / evidence now → going to.
- Decision now, offer, promise, opinion (I think, probably) → will.
- won't = will not; I'll = I will.
- Never two futures together: *will going to* ✗.

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